

01 Read and think

Read the question and Muzna's answer. Don't correct it yet.
What do you think Muzna does well? What is weak or difficult?

IELTS Writing Task 2

Some people think governments should make healthy food cheaper to encourage people to eat a better diet. Others believe people should be responsible for making their own food choices.

Discuss both views and give your own opinion.

Muzna's answer

about healthy food many people now they know is important but when go supermarket the good food sometimes expensive and family will take what is cheap not what is better for health cos if you have childrens and need buy food every day the price is very important goverment can help for this problem make fruit and vegtables cheaper and maybe people will buy more of them and this can reduce sickness also in future but not every person will change what they eating only for price some people like fast food becos taste and is easy when finish work and tired they dont want cooking and this is another problem for example if someone work 10 hours he can buy burger very fast but healthy meal need make at home and take more time so only make vegetables cheap will not change him also companys have responsability cos they put many sugar and salt inside food and people not alwase know what they are eating goverment can obligate them to show information more clear and schools also can learn young people about food before they get older but i think person also need make own decision becos goverment cannot be with you when you choice what eat and if someone know a food is bad but eat it every day this is his decision however some family dont have same choice becos healthy products can be high price and this is not fair especially people have low salary in my opinion goverment should make healthy food more possible for everyiore and give education about it but people need also be responsable for them self if both do this maybe health problems can decrease and people have better life

02 What do you think?

Read Muzna's answer again. Then give a score from 1 to 4 for each question. Find something in her writing that supports your score.

There are no right or wrong answers at this stage. Think and discuss.

1 **How well does Muzna answer the question?** 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐

My comment (find an example from the writing):

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2 **How well does Muzna explain and develop her ideas?** 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐

My comment (find an example from the writing):

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How well does she organise the answer into an introduction, two paragraphs and a conclusion? 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐

My comment (find an example from the writing):

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How well does she link ideas together using linking words and phrases? 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐

My comment (find an example from the writing):

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3 **How good is Muzna's variety of grammar?** 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐

My comment (find an example from the writing):

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How well does she control her grammar? 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐

My comment (find an example from the writing):

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How well does she control capital letters, full stops and commas? 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐

My comment (find an example from the writing):

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4 **How well does Muzna use a variety of simple and more difficult words?** 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐

My comment (find an example from the writing):

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How well does she avoid repeating the same words? 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐

My comment (find an example from the writing):

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How well does she control spelling? 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐

My comment (find an example from the writing):

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Why do you think many people choose this kind of food?



What could help people eat more healthy food?

03 How does IELTS see it?

Here is an example of how an examiner might assess Muzna's writing.
Remember: this is not the only possible score, but it shows you the kind of level this answer can reach.



Overall band score

5.0

There are a lot of mistakes, but Muzna does answer the question and gives relevant ideas. This can reach around Band 5.0.

Task Response — Band 6.0

Muzna discusses both views and gives her own opinion. She has relevant ideas and some good examples.

What she does well

"goverment can help for this problem make fruit and vegtables cheaper"

"person also need make own decision"

What holds her back

Some ideas are not fully developed and the opinion could be clearer earlier in the answer.

Coherence & Cohesion — Band 5.0

Muzna's ideas follow a logical order and there are clear groups of ideas, but there are no paragraph breaks and linking is sometimes limited.

What she does well

"for example if someone work 10 hours..."
"but I think person also need make own decision..."

What holds her back

The whole answer is one long paragraph and she repeats some linking words. Ideas can be difficult to follow because sentences are very long.

Grammatical Range & Accuracy — Band 4.0

Muzna uses a range of sentence types and tries more complex ideas, but there are many grammar mistakes. There are also few capital letters, full stops or commas.

What she does well

"if someone work 10 hours..."
"when you choice what eat..."

What holds her back

Frequent errors with verb forms, articles and sentence structure. Very limited punctuation.

Lexical Resource — Band 5.0

Muzna uses a mix of simple and more difficult words. She shows some good vocabulary, but there is repetition and many spelling mistakes.

What she does well

"reduce sickness"
"obligate them to show information"

What holds her back

Several spelling mistakes and some awkward word choices. She also repeats common words like food, people, government and healthy.



What did Muzna already do well?

- She answered the question and gave relevant ideas.
- She discussed both views and gave her own opinion.
- She gave examples and showed some good vocabulary.

What could Muzna improve quite easily?

1. Use clear paragraphs: introduction, two paragraphs and a conclusion.
2. Finish your sentences with full stops.
3. Check a few common grammar patterns (for example: verb forms and articles).
4. Avoid repeating the same words and check spelling.

How much do spelling and grammar affect my IELTS score?

They matter, but less than you might think.



Your IELTS result is based on four skills equally weighted.

Listening	Reading	**Writing**	Speaking
25%	**25%**	**25%**	**25%**

Each writing task is assessed on four equally weighted criteria.

(Task 2 is worth twice as much as Task 1.)

Task Response / Achievement	Coherence & Cohesion	**Lexical Resource**	**Grammatical Range & Accuracy**
25%	**25%**	**25%**	**25%**

Lexical Resource

25% of each writing task

IELTS looks at several things, not just spelling.

- **Range** — A variety of vocabulary (simple and more advanced words).
- **Appropriacy** — Choosing words that are suitable for the topic and the academic style.
- **Precision** — Using the right word for the meaning.
- **Collocation** — How well words naturally go together.
- **Word formation** — Using different forms of words (e.g. noun, verb, adjective).
- **Spelling** — How accurately words are spelled.

The whole of Lexical Resource is **25%** of each writing task.

↓

This is about **6.25%** of your overall IELTS result.

Spelling is only one part of this, not the whole 6.25%.

Grammatical Range & Accuracy

25% of each writing task

IELTS looks at both the range and the accuracy of your grammar.

- **Range** — Using a variety of sentence structures (simple and more complex).
- **Accuracy** — How correctly you use grammar in your sentences.
- **Control** — Using grammar forms confidently and consistently.
- **Complex structures** — Trying more complex ideas (e.g. *if*, *although*, *when*, relative clauses, comparisons).
- **Punctuation** — Using capital letters, full stops and commas correctly.

The whole of Grammatical Range & Accuracy is **25%** of each writing task.

↓

This is about **6.25%** of your overall IELTS result.

Accuracy is only one part of this, not the whole 6.25%.

Key idea

- Spelling and grammar do affect your score.
- They are important, but they are not the only things IELTS looks at.
- You can still get a reasonable band score even if you make some mistakes, as long as your ideas are relevant, well organised and generally clear.

Focus on the whole answer not just individual mistakes.